

英検準1級 リーディング問題

2024年度 第2回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

ReadPassで復習

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(1) A few characters in the new movie are based on real people, but most of the characters are completely (1).

- 1 tender 2 vigorous 3 influential 4 fictitious

(2) To protect government secrets, high-level workers must complete a security check before they can view (2) documents.

- 1 shrewd 2 defective 3 serene 4 classified

(3) Rashid was hoping to stay in his university dormitory for two weeks after classes ended, but he was told that all students had to (3) their rooms immediately.

- 1 vacate 2 pledge 3 offend 4 squeeze

(4) Ethan's wife believes he (4) their daughter. He often allows the girl to do whatever she wants, and he rarely punishes her when she misbehaves.

- 1 harbors 2 defies 3 retains 4 spoils

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q9

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (5) Two students were caught fighting in the school hallway. They were sent to the principal's office for (5) action.

1 tranquil 2 conceptual 3 disciplinary 4 discriminatory

- (6) A report that one of the company's products was dangerous caused (6) in the office. Many employees were fired, and others worked nonstop to address the legal problems caused by the report.

1 turmoil 2 sarcasm 3 upkeep 4 heritage

- (7) After the hockey team won the tournament, they celebrated their (7) by going out to a local pizza restaurant.

1 corridor 2 tag 3 triumph 4 clarity

- (8) **A:** Please (8) my best wishes to your husband.
B: Thank you. I will. He's away now, but I'll tell him when he gets back.

1 command 2 convey 3 install 4 prescribe

- (9) **A:** Angus, where's that terrible (9) coming from?
B: Sorry, Salma, that's the garbage. I haven't taken it out in a few days.

1 strain 2 obedience 3 temper 4 odor

大問1 語彙・文法 Q10-Q14

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(10) After growing up in a small village, it was a big shock for Shiori to move to a (10) populated city like Tokyo.

- 1 densely 2 virtually 3 flexibly 4 suspiciously

(11) Pedro has a (11) way of eating waffles. Instead of using something sweet, such as maple syrup, he likes eating them with mustard.

- 1 charitable 2 numb 3 surplus 4 bizarre

(12) Kevin could not untie the (12) in his shoelace, so he asked his father to help him with it.

- 1 flock 2 knot 3 gleam 4 doom

(13) There was a (13) silence in the room after the company president suddenly announced that she was quitting. No one could believe it was really happening.

- 1 dutiful 2 nutritious 3 stunned 4 cherished

(14) In one part of the cave, the ceiling was so low that Vikram had to (14) on his hands and knees for about ten meters.

- 1 crawl 2 mourn 3 meditate 4 haunt

大問1 語彙・文法 Q15-Q18

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(15)

A: I can't believe you (15) the ending of the movie!

B: Sorry, I thought you had seen it before.

1 phased out

2 shook up

3 burned off

4 gave away

(16)

Daisuke's parents are very strict, and it can be difficult for him to (16) their expectations. He needs to spend a lot of time studying to get grades that will satisfy them.

1 live up to

2 hold off on

3 meet up with

4 break in on

(17)

Though some of the other students found the class difficult, Deepak (17) it easily. He was able to get a very high grade despite hardly studying at all.

1 happened upon

2 stayed off

3 sailed through

4 glared at

(18)

Mark began his speech with jokes and funny stories to (18) his audience. Once they were listening carefully, he began talking about what he really wanted to say.

1 scratch out

2 win over

3 rack up

4 indulge in

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q19-Q21

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Liberty Ships

Before the United States entered World War II, it was officially neutral in the conflict. Nevertheless, (19). Great Britain and other Allied nations were desperate for material aid to continue the fight against Germany. In the form of steel, foodstuffs, and other essential goods, the United States provided a lifeline. After the United States officially joined the Allied war effort, the expansion of material support, including aircraft, trucks, and ammunition, necessitated a massive boost in cargo shipping.

Much of the aid was ferried across the Atlantic Ocean, and so-called Liberty ships provided the backbone of this effort. Thanks to technological improvements, crossing the often-rough Atlantic had generally become a less dangerous prospect for ships in the 1940s than it had been just a few decades earlier. In wartime, however, (20). Liberty ships were slow, and German submarines patrolled Atlantic waters. Attacks were a constant worry, and some ships - along with their crews - were lost.

Submarines were not the only problem. As the war progressed, production of Liberty ships increased, and it eventually ran into the thousands. Unfortunately, some ships had structural issues. Their hulls cracked, and some ships sank at sea. Despite such tragic losses, most Liberty ships operated throughout the war. Some people argue that the role these and other ships played in helping to turn the war in the Allies' favor should not be underestimated. (21), the shipyards where the Liberty ships were assembled were often located in relatively low-income areas. The employment that the shipyards provided was a boon to local economies.

(19)

- 1 its economy suffered badly 2 it did not help Great Britain 3 its actions told a different story 4 it needed assistance

(20)

- 1 a new threat appeared 2 more ships were available 3 ships only traveled at night 4 crews had to be paid more

(21)

- 1 On the contrary 2 Subsequently 3 Moreover 4 In exchange

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q22-Q24

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Going Underground

In the mid-nineteenth century, street congestion in London had, some argued, reached unacceptable levels. Various urban transportation solutions had been proposed and rejected. However, the concept of an underground railway appealed to some political leaders, and despite years of debate, construction was approved. In historical terms, the Metropolitan Railway, as it was called, is seen as a (22). Once completed, it became the world's first underground railway line. After ferrying millions of passengers in the first year alone, its success helped kickstart the London Underground subway system.

Nevertheless, the project was (23). Engineers had to ensure the tunnels, branch lines, arches, and maintenance access points were constructed precisely and safely. Though skilled, the engineers lacked the technologically advanced devices that engineering firms possess today. The fear of tunnels collapsing was uppermost in many people's minds. In reality, it was just one of many concerns. Records indicate that in one incident, a boiler exploded, causing fatalities; in another, nearby pipes burst, leading to flooding and delays in construction.

Some observers believe little consideration was given to the effect that early subway construction projects would have on some sections of London's population. Today, subway projects often proceed deep underground with minimal disruption to people's daily lives. (24), early subway tunnels were created in a less sophisticated way. Long holes were dug into the streets; then, tunnels were built and covered with roadways. To facilitate such work, Parliament granted land, sometimes in slum areas, to the construction companies. As a result, thousands of poor people were displaced.

(22)

- 1 cost-saving success
- 2 waste of time and energy
- 3 way to distract the public
- 4 revolutionary step

(23)

- 1 underfunded from the start
- 2 not without obstacles
- 3 almost canceled
- 4 moved to a safer location

(24)

- 1 Consequently
- 2 In contrast
- 3 Likewise
- 4 On top of that

大問3A 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ25-Q27に答えなさい。

Measuring Intelligence

Intelligence quotient, commonly known as IQ, claims to be a numerical representation of a person's cognitive ability or intelligence. The first IQ test was developed in the early 1900s by a French psychologist named Alfred Binet. Binet was asked by the French government to create a test that could be used to identify children who needed educational support. The Binet-Simon test that was created as a result provided the foundation for all IQ tests that have been produced since. Because they were a quick and easy way to categorize people, IQ tests soon became a popular tool in educational and employment settings to measure student performance and assess potential new recruits.

Although IQ tests are now widely used, there is ongoing debate regarding their validity. One issue raised by critics relates to the nature of intelligence. IQ tests are based on the principle that all aspects of intelligence can be measured by one standardized test of general cognitive ability. However, a large-scale study carried out in Canada suggests that this model of intelligence is too simple. In the study, which included over 100,000 participants, researchers asked subjects to answer questions that targeted a range of cognitive skills. As expected, some participants were better at answering the questions than others, but the researchers believed this could only be explained by considering three different aspects of mental ability - short-term memory, reasoning, and verbal skills. Furthermore, MRI scans taken while a small group of the participants were answering questions indicated that each of these abilities was controlled by a different region in the brain.

Despite this criticism, proponents of IQ tests believe they can be beneficial if used appropriately. In US schools, for example, children from ethnic minorities tend to be overlooked for gifted education programs. One reason for this is that, historically, candidates for such programs have been selected based on referrals from teachers. Studies have shown that the academic performance and behavior of students are influenced by their teachers' attitudes toward them, which may, in turn, be affected by the teachers' subconscious racial biases. Since the majority of teachers in US schools are White, students from ethnic minorities tend to have less chance of being selected for such programs. However, in US school districts where IQ tests have been used in the selection process, more students from ethnic minorities have been able to enter the programs. Supporters of the tests say they are a fairer selection method because they provide an objective measure of ability.

大問3A 長文設問 Q25-Q27

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (25) According to the first paragraph, what is true about Alfred Binet?
- 1 The test he developed was not initially intended for the purpose of measuring intelligence in children.
 - 2 The test he designed became the basis for all IQ tests that have been developed since.
 - 3 He lost his job with the French government because of his strong opinions regarding IQ tests.
 - 4 He was not the first person to attempt to create a test that could be used to measure a person's intelligence.

- (26) A study in Canada suggested that
- 1 although intelligence consists of several different aspects, it is dependent on the function of just one part of the brain.
 - 2 while most IQ tests are based on valid research, the way they are carried out makes them ineffective.
 - 3 IQ tests are designed based on the mistaken concept that intelligence is a single ability that can be measured in isolation.
 - 4 evidence from brain scans indicates there is less variation in people's intelligence than was previously believed.

- (27) What does the author of the passage say about gifted education programs in US schools?
- 1 IQ tests are being misused by teachers as a way to determine which students should enter such programs.
 - 2 Results of IQ tests provide little help in predicting how well students in such programs will perform.
 - 3 Students from ethnic minorities tend to perform better in such programs than White students do.
 - 4 The use of IQ tests has given students from ethnic minorities a better chance of entering such programs.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ28-Q31に答えなさい。

Age and Innovation

One benchmark that is used to measure technological progress is Moore's law. This law, which was originally published by US engineer and businessman Gordon Moore in 1965, states that the number of transistors on a microchip will double every two years. Moore originally intended this as a prediction regarding computer technology, but it became the driving force behind the rapid progress in computer technology that has occurred since then. The law implied that computers would continue to become smaller and more powerful, and tech companies started to plan their product development around this principle. Most experts now consider that Moore's law was responsible for innovations such as home computers and smartphones that have become essential parts of modern life.

Moore's law has largely held true, but only because the amount of manpower and time used to make it possible have also greatly increased. As a paper by researchers from two universities in the United States concludes, "The constant exponential growth implied by Moore's law has been achieved only by a staggering increase in the amount of resources devoted to pushing the frontier forward." In fact, the number of researchers required to maintain the same level of innovation today is around seventy-five times more than it was in the early 1970s. Similarly, there is a general trend in many areas of society for significant progress to take longer. Political and business leaders are getting older, the average age of Nobel Prize winners is rising, and groundbreaking scientific discoveries are being made less frequently.

One theory put forward to explain this tendency is the "burden of knowledge." This states that as more innovations are made, the amount of knowledge required to make new ones grows. Innovations occur as a result of using past knowledge to find solutions to problems, so each generation has to learn an increasing amount of previously accrued knowledge before it can begin to innovate for itself. The only way to do this is to study more, which inevitably takes longer. Some studies in Germany showed that the average age of researchers in the field of mathematics when they published their first journal articles rose by five years between 1950 and 2013. The number of references to other research that were cited in the articles also increased by five times over the same period.

A further obstacle to scientific and technological innovation often cited by economists is the fact that populations are aging. It is believed by some that an aging workforce holds back new discoveries because older workers are less able to learn new skills and less willing to adopt new knowledge. However, some experts believe the opposite to be true. Better diets, advances in medicine, and improved health care mean that people today not only live longer but also stay physically and mentally active until a later age. In addition, because of their experience, older workers are more efficient - and therefore more productive - than their younger colleagues and play valuable roles in passing on knowledge. These factors help to promote innovation and counterbalance the effects of the burden of knowledge.

大問3B 長文設問 Q28-Q31

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (28) What is one thing the author of the passage says about Moore's law?
- 1 It overestimated the impact that advances in computer technology would have on our lives.
 - 2 It is unlikely to be accurate in the future because of the increasingly rapid rate at which companies release new products.
 - 3 It not only predicted technological progress but also stimulated the development of new technology.
 - 4 It was an effective way to predict advances in technology despite the fact that it was intended for a different purpose.
- (29) A paper by researchers in the United States concluded that
- 1 there is evidence to show that Moore's law can also be a useful tool in the field of politics.
 - 2 the amount of effort that is necessary for Moore's law to remain true has increased greatly over time.
 - 3 while the age of leaders in the worlds of business and politics is increasing, this is not the case for Nobel Prize winners.
 - 4 universities in the United States are unlikely to make major new discoveries because they have limited resources.
- (30) What is suggested by the theory mentioned in the third paragraph?
- 1 Breakthroughs in science and technology are becoming more difficult to achieve because of a continually growing pool of knowledge.
 - 2 Although researchers today are very knowledgeable, they are less skilled at applying their knowledge to practical situations.
 - 3 The quality of journal articles in mathematics has improved despite the fact that the field attracts fewer researchers than it used to.
 - 4 New innovations improve society in certain ways, but their overall effect may not be positive in the long term.
- (31) According to the final paragraph, what do some experts believe?
- 1 Mistaken ideas about the effects of an aging workforce lead to companies losing some of their most valuable workers.
 - 2 A lack of government spending on health care will cause a rise in the number of older people who are unable to work due to poor health.
 - 3 Because younger workers have to make up for the low productivity of their older colleagues, the chance of innovations occurring is reduced.
 - 4 Rather than slowing down innovation, an aging workforce may make it more likely to happen.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。 大問3は正解番号のみを表示しています。



Q01-Q11		Q12-Q21		Q22-Q31	
Q01	4	Q12	2	Q22	4
fictitious		knot		revolutionary step	
Q02	4	Q13	3	Q23	2
classified		stunned		not without obstacles	
Q03	1	Q14	1	Q24	2
vacate		crawl		In contrast	
Q04	4	Q15	4	Q25	2
spoils		gave away			
Q05	3	Q16	1	Q26	3
disciplinary		live up to			
Q06	1	Q17	3	Q27	4
turmoil		sailed through			
Q07	3	Q18	2	Q28	3
triumph		win over			
Q08	2	Q19	3	Q29	2
convey		its actions told a different story			
Q09	4	Q20	1	Q30	1
odor		a new threat appeared			
Q10	1	Q21	3	Q31	4
densely		Moreover			
Q11	4				
bizarre					

学習記録	得点	_____ / 31	やり直す問題	_____
	メモ	_____		